

Event

Overview

In 2018, while working on a casual contract in Medical Records, I provided my diploma of fitness as an accredited diploma while studying as a second-year nursing student. It was communicated that accredited payment for recognized Australian education would be given, along with additional payments. However, upon reviewing a colleague's pay slip, I realized that these additional payments were never received. I feel as though after many requests which have been met with hostility while both declining payments and not paying overtime at all it generally stresses me that I don't feel I can even request my own entitlements

Chloe Taylor the newly appointed manager seems determined to make me feel undervalued in the switchboard department and my knowledge with computers health and communication as a third-year nursing student is undermined by both her and the rumors she spreads to new employees within the department.

Initially when I moved to the Switchboard Services department on a casual contract, Sandra Johnstone at the time was the manager and has now departed. I again have given my diploma during the application process and for the role in switchboard was deemed competent within 5 days, whereas most employees require 3 weeks of training.

While Sandra was the manager and I was working 2-4 days per week on a casual basis, I signed an agreement allowing for an 8-hour break between shifts, even though the standard break is 10 hours or fatigue pay is provided. I believe Chloe Taylor was not privileged to this information.

I am no longer a nursing student and work as a full-time permanent employee. However, while employed under the manager Sandra I moved to a permanent contract which was an .8% allocation.

Since 2021, our department has faced ongoing issues due to numerous employee departures, including the manager, Sandra. During this time, I was not informed about an open managerial role, which was instead filled by Danielle Cook and Chloe Taylor.

Additionally, another employee left the department, and Danielle Cook hired Cherie Abbott as a full-time employee without advertising the position or giving other employees the chance to apply. This was approved by Director Tammy Reece.

There has also been a reduction in penalty shifts and an increase in fatigue due to poor roster development. I believe this situation is unfair, as my experience has been undervalued in favor of less qualified individuals, often due to biases or friendships.

My initial concern was about the roster, penalty shifts, overtime, and policy decisions.

Other employees were granted shifts based on their requests, while my requests for days off, made months in advance, were ignored and conveniently my days requested off would be taken as leave not scheduled around it like Chloe's friends.

Although I was available to work a rotating 24/7 roster, it was not fairly allocated. Employees favored by Chloe received shifts according to their requests, while I was subjected to arbitrary scheduling. This inconsistent application of rostering guidelines negatively impacted my income and caused fatigue.

Following my initial complaint, I noticed a change in how I was treated. The 7:00 AM shift finishes exacerbated my fatigue and were consistent or purposeful, this finishing time increasing my travel time to two hours compared to one hour for a 6:00 AM finish. Additionally, issues with shift assignments, workload, call stats, overtime shifts, and sick leave absences arose. I believe my questioning of policies and processes was perceived as a challenge to both the manager and Director, leading to further tension.

In an initial meeting with the Director, we agreed to discuss the 7:00 AM finishes in a group meeting with Chloe and Tammy. I provided multiple roster samples and fatigue management studies to support my case. Information about our agreement regarding rostering and public holidays, including paid leave if not required, has been shared with both the Director and manager.

Additionally, the department was informed that a union delegate was needed as per policy. I initially raised this due to the lack of a point of contact for departmental issues. Upon discovering the absence of a union delegate, I volunteered to undergo training and agreed that other employees should be given the opportunity. Chloe committed to sending an email to the department offering this fair chance to everyone.

When permanent employees left and more shifts became available, instead of offering or reallocating those shifts, Chloe quickly assigned temporary contracts to casual employees, delaying full-time conversions. This action, overseen by the Director, led me to send an email outlining the relevant information. Eventually, I secured a full-time permanent position. Despite this, workplace issues persisted. I reached out to the union, only to receive no response for two months, after which I was told I owed fees. I refused to pay for an unresponsive service.

After providing numerous rosters and being transparent in my efforts to resolve scheduling issues, Tammy maintained that Chloe would continue preparing the roster every fortnight. Complaints among employees regarding expectations and responsibilities continued.

One of the department tasks involves updating doctors' phone numbers. Over a three-month period, six staff members, including friends, failed to notice updates, which I interpreted as following another's lead. I corrected the mistake and noted the importance of verifying numbers in the communication book. The following day, I found the note torn from the book. After just ten minutes on shift, Chloe and Tahia accused me of malicious intent. I documented this incident with other employees present, who confirmed that there was no ill intent. Despite fixing long-missed updates and drafting a new template, Chloe and her friend Tahia took offense, resulting in abusive behavior towards me.

If necessary Sonja and Cory-Harrison Jones could be called as witnesses to the event. Sonja can attest to the drafted document, while Cory, the other employee on shift, can confirm how I was spoken to.

With an extensive diversity of skills background and experience, I found it increasingly difficult to communicate effectively with the Director and the manager as every action seemed to be against both legislation, policy and interest. I would feel any raised concerns would be met with grief.

More recently, Ellen Stibbard was employed by the department, while staff had their computer access was further limited by both the Manager and Director without prior advice, then access given to Ellen so she could have the newly created job. Employees were then instructed to send updates and liaise with or answer Ellen. No consultation, advice, transparency, or equal opportunity was provided by Tammy Reece. Ellen, a

friend hired prematurely, had her role officially advertised three months later. Ellen expressed confidence that she would secure the position, which she did shortly after. I chose not to apply, although another employee did, but the process felt disruptive and unfair.

The principles of equal opportunity and departmental consultation were ignored, and transparency was lacking. I believe the code of conduct and relevant legislation were violated, pointing to corruption within the department. The department often experienced many directives and unilateral decisions by management, with frequent absenteeism from their offices.

Furthermore, payment issues arose:

While I was off work due to COVID, Chloe decided not to process my income despite receiving an email with the necessary documentation. She insisted I submit the document through HR and maliciously declined my submission twice, despite it being uploaded and approvable via email.

Regarding family matters, I informed Chloe that I would be delayed working by approximately one hour. Despite notifying her 1 hour and 45 minutes before my shift, she canceled my shift without pay. Although I was supposed to be at work by 8:00 AM, Chloe contacted Jude, who arrived at 8:40 AM. Chloe did not pay me for the shift, displaying both a lack of empathy and abuse of her role.

Addressing roster issues, I raised concerns about fatigue pay via email. Chloe stated she needed to consult HR about my underpayment. After a lengthy process and working the shifts in question, Chloe ultimately rejected my claim, citing an agreement for an eight-hour break between shifts, which contradicted my full-time contract and applied their agreement made while I was working 2 times a week.

In my response, I referenced my travel time and pointed out that she was wrongfully applying an agreement made during my time as a casual employee. I have been employed in the department for the same length of time as her and have not been a casual employee for a considerable period. Despite this, there was no further correspondence from her, and no payment was made.

I provided numerous rostering examples demonstrating that employees should never be scheduled for only a 10-hour break. There is no formal policy on this, as such short breaks would typically only occur due to overtime, which is an exceptional

circumstance. According to the rostering policies, no manager would plan to give their employee a 10-hour break. Furthermore, I would never agree to an 8-hour break without compensation while working five shifts a week on a full-time contract.

I raised concerns again about the department operating without a Union delegate. Chloe responded by saying that no one replied to the email she sent to see if there was any interest in the role, and she told me that I must no longer be interested because I didn't respond either. However, just the day prior, Chloe had received email correspondence from me expressing my ongoing interest in the position. My interest never wavered, and I was never directly asked about taking on the role, despite it being a departmental requirement. I believe Chloe avoided appointing me as the delegate on purpose.

There has been a noticeable increase in complaints within the department. Additionally, overtime payments have not been processed. Despite multiple calls and emails to payroll, I have received no response. I attached these emails to my correspondence, while Chloe sent additional emails informing me that she was still awaiting a reply from payroll.

Chloe has consistently ignored recommendations regarding the on-call process, resulting in missed opportunities for fairness and equal remuneration. Over the past year, concerns about adherence to the on-call process have persisted. Chloe does not address employees who fail to follow the process, nor does she adhere to it herself. Without departmental input, Chloe and Ellen allocated themselves as the on-call contacts after hours. This arrangement is ineffective since they often miss calls or texts while sleeping. Furthermore, Chloe has failed to process any overtime payments or address any concerns raised by me but has been able to have the Director allocate more income to herself. This demonstrates a lack of concern for the required response times and for my finances, which remain unprocessed.

After issuing these immediate illegal and unethical directions, Chloe further compounded the issue by gifting one of my public holiday shifts to another employee without offering it to others or following the established process that ensures a fair workplace.

Chloe frequently issues directives without consultation or input, making them effective immediately. This has led to a significant increase in complaints, including those from doctors, and has negatively impacted patient safety. Chloe aims to assert her authority, often while not physically present, and by ignoring legal and hospital policies. She

deflects blame for complaints onto the switchboard and inconsistently directs additional pager tests via ambiguous emails.

In the Masper process email flow, Chloe blames the switchboard and requests the business hours of a doctor, claiming difficulty in reaching them. This directive did not provide the necessary information for the department but rather set a troubling precedent. The email flow highlights a fear of employee error and a need for clarity among staff responsible for sending pager tests while doctors are engaged in emergency care.

To ensure staff understanding, a group email was sent. Chloe responded to this email to assert her ultimate decision-making authority, again unclear and ambiguous to staff that are new to the department, in another email Chloe wrote that the mistakes were the department's fault. When I raised concerns, Chloe dismissed them and reaffirmed that her directives are final. I feel that many decisions made are without proper diligence or investigating the issues, leading to more complaints, which I often end up responsible for addressing over the phone.

****NOTES****

Chloe shut me down in a condescending manner while I was following directives in our email exchange. The email flow revealed that the issue involved both doctors and departmental concerns.

Before fully understanding the situation, I was directly involved in a delay of urgent pathology results because I followed Chloe's immediate, non-inclusive decisions that lacked evidence.

After the email regarding the Massper register and my experience dealing with it, I urgently need Chloe to comprehend the importance of making informed decisions with evidence and inclusive consultation. With reference to our inability to access business hours without privilege, I sent an email to our department requesting transparency regarding Chloe's business hours and emphasized that decisions should be made in consultation with the department, in line with both legal and Hospital and Health Service agreements which require Chloe to consult the team before making decisions.

Chloe is often not in the office, leaves early, and makes unilateral decisions without evidence, which has caused significant issues. The email I sent was brought to the Director, who accused me of being disrespectful and demanded that I retract it.

Once again, I have been shut down, and for the first time, faced accusations of breaching policy. Throughout my career, whether working with international hospital health services or at Logan Hospital, I have always adhered to extensive procedures and policies. Despite this, I find myself unable to communicate effectively, meet expectations, or contact Chloe when she's in the office. Requesting adherence to legislation has been deemed offensive and disrespectful.

I find it unfair that Chloe can request a doctor's hours, mention a phone being off, and share privileged departmental emails without consequence, while my attempt to prevent delays in patient treatment provokes such accusations.

Following Tammy Reece email, I have retracted my email. To this day, no claims have been made against Chloe regarding the same behavior. I believe I am being treated differently than other staff members in this matter, likely due to the wrongful behavior of my manager.

Chloe has since sent out a group email which was ambiguous and unclear during office hours and proceeded to make fun of me about the meaning of consultation in emails that and demeaning. It has become increasingly difficult to communicate within the department, as some employees engage in bullying, spread rumors, and undermine my employment. Chloe persists in malicious emails and giving special treatment to less experienced employees as she ensures my workload is higher and I take a heavy amount of phone calls as she allows others to walk from the room. During such times I have raised formal requests as a right to access calls stats to identify the difference which have also been ignored.

In addition to this there are several other employees that are employed within the department experiencing very similar issues. Employees such as Carolyn, Patricia, Corey, Pete and I am sure others. The director is also aware of my concerns yet accompanying the issues. This behavior is evident in the attachments and is ongoing. This is a brief overview and every shift worked in the department seems difficult and a hostile environment and workplace as Chloe aims employees against each other.

Kind regards,

Cory